

WEEKLY PROJECT REPORT

Project Title: AI-Based GST Compliance Helper for MSMEs using OCR and Automated Reconciliation

Role: Customer Contact Lead

Week: 1

Name: Ananya R Biradar

1. Objectives for the Week

- To understand the GST system and its working
- To identify real-world problems faced by MSMEs in GST compliance
- To initiate communication with potential users

2. Activities Performed

- Studied the basics of GST including:
 - GSTIN structure
 - Types of taxes (CGST, SGST, IGST)
 - Invoice formats and components
- Interacted with MSME business owners and accountants
- Observed how businesses:
 - Maintain invoices
 - Perform GST filing
 - Handle reconciliation
- Collected initial information on challenges faced during GST compliance

3. Key Findings / Insights

- Most MSMEs rely on manual or semi-digital processes
- Common issues identified:
 - Manual data entry errors
 - Difficulty in reconciliation
 - Time-consuming GST filing

- Invoices are stored in multiple formats (paper, PDF, images)
- Users lack clear visibility of:
 - Errors
 - Tax status
 - ITC claims

4. Contribution to Project Development

- Identified real-world problems to guide project direction
- Helped define the problem statement
- Provided initial requirements for system features
- Ensured project is based on actual user needs

5. Challenges Faced

- Understanding GST concepts in initial stages
- Communicating effectively with non-technical users
- Collecting consistent information from different users

6. Learning Outcomes

- Gained basic understanding of GST system and workflow
- Learned how businesses handle compliance in real life
- Developed communication and requirement-gathering skills
- Understood importance of user-centric design

7. Plan for Next Week

- Conduct more detailed discussions with users
- Refine and validate collected requirements
- Identify key features for the system
- Begin structuring requirements for development

8. Conclusion

This week focused on understanding GST compliance and identifying real-world challenges faced by MSMEs. The insights gathered form the foundation for designing a practical and effective solution.